



MUMBAI | Golden Claim

Belgaum, it seems, is not going to be the only bone of contention between Maharashtra and Karnataka. The Shiv Sena is gearing up to wage a bigger battle for the integration of Nipani, Bidar, Karwar and Bhalki into Maharashtra. Rekindling the *Samyukta Maharashtra* issue on the state's golden jubilee day, Sena Supremo Bal Thackeray said, "The agitation of *Samyukta* (united) *Maharashtra* is still not over. We have to regain our lost territories from Karnataka." Bringing up the issue ahead of the Brihanmumbai Municipal Corporation elections in 2012, the Shiv Sena aims to win the *Marathi manoos* over the rival Maharashtra Navnirman Sena (MNS) but this will put its ally, the BJP, in a quandary. The BJP has to support the Sena in this newly restored agenda, even though it is the ruling party in Karnataka.

by Mitali Patel

DELHI | Web of War

Waking up belatedly to the recent cyber attacks by China on the PMO, National Security Council and Defence Ministry, the Government has constituted an inter-ministerial taskforce to evaluate India's preparedness for such attacks. Formed by Cabinet Secretary K.M. Chandra-shekhar, it comprises 12 agencies, including the CEID, R&AW, IB, CERT, DRI, NIA, NCB and NCRB. Headed by the chairman of the National Technical Research Organisation, the commission has to submit its report in a month.

by Sandeep Unnithan

DELHI | Mind Your Language

Home Minister P. Chidambaram is by now used to fighting fire, friendly or otherwise. But even he was taken aback recently when Samajwadi Party leader Ram Gopal Yadav fired a surprise missile during a Parliament discussion on the working of the Home Ministry. Speaking in Hindi, Yadav objected to Chidambaram removing his headphones during his speech, saying that the minister wasn't paying attention as he did not know Hindi. If this wasn't enough, Yadav told Chidambaram, who heads the Committee on National Language, that he should ensure letters written to various ministries in Hindi should be replied to in Hindi and not English. What they didn't teach him at Harvard, Chidambaram will now be learning from the cowbelt.

by Priya Sahgal

AN SP MP RECENTLY ASKED CHIDAMBARAM TO ENSURE THAT LETTERS WRITTEN TO MINISTRIES IN HINDI SHOULD BE ANSWERED IN HINDI TOO.

VERBAL PERMISSION IS ALL THAT PARTIES NEED TO PAINT ON ANYONE'S WALL.

KOLKATA | Writing on the Wall

The news is not official yet but word is that the Left Front Government will allow graffiti on walls to all for the upcoming corporation elections. With only "verbal" permission needed for painting walls, the worst sufferer will be the common man. During the Lok Sabha elections last year, the Election Commission had ruled that written permission had to be acquired from owners of non-government property for graffiti for the civic polls. This now has been done away with. Even though there is a clause to oppose graffiti on the walls, no owner will even let out a whimper of protest, given the nature of those who will be working on the electoral graffiti. This decision will bring with it clashes between the Left and Trinamool supporters and the Congress, too, will be able to join in the battle for the walls.

by Abhijit Dasgupta



PARTY SLOGANS BEING PAINTED ON CITY WALLS